

ASHRAF K YOUSEF

Assistant Bar Manager | Beverage Operations Specialist

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Availability: Immediate (Can Join Immediately)



PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Commercially minded Beverage Operations Leader with 11+ years of UAE hospitality experience, progressing from Bartender to Assistant Bar Manager. Contributed to improving beverage cost performance from approximately 28–30% to an 18–24% range over roughly three months through stronger inventory control and a self-designed digital stock-counting process. Experienced leading beverage teams of up to 44 staff and training 20–30 team members in operational, technical and service standards. Combines hands-on, calm-under-pressure leadership with a systems and technology mindset — designing digital tools for SOP training and cocktail costing, and applying AI to turn operational data into actionable insight. Targeting Assistant Bar Manager roles, with a clear trajectory toward Bar Manager and Beverage Manager.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- Beverage Cost Control & Pour Cost Analysis
- Inventory Management & Stock Reconciliation
- Menu Engineering & Recipe Costing
- Team Leadership & Training (44-member teams)
- SOPs & Operational Standards
- Pre-Opening Operations
- Commercial KPIs (GP, Sales Mix, Average Check)
- AI-Assisted Operational Analysis
- Digital Systems Design (SOP & Costing Tools)
- Guest Experience & Upselling

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Assistant Bar Manager

Jan 2021 – Dec 2025

Bla Bla Dubai (McGettigan's), Dubai, UAE — Pre-Opening

Career Progression: Bartender → Floor Supervisor → Assistant Bar Manager

- Progressed through three roles over five years, earning increasing responsibility across the venue's beverage operation.
- Led a beverage team of 44 (32 bartenders, 12 barbacks); trained approximately 20–30 team members across operational SOPs, recipe standards, bar techniques and service standards.
- Identified wastage, inaccurate stock counting and inventory discrepancies as root causes of high beverage cost (~28–30%); introduced a digital, phone-based stock-counting workflow with live visibility through a web application.
- Contributed to improving beverage cost performance from approximately 28–30% to an 18–24% range over approximately three months through stronger inventory control and the new digital process.
- Tracked beverage cost %, stock variance, inventory accuracy, sales mix, average check, gross profit and pour cost % as core commercial KPIs.
- Drove menu engineering, recipe costing and upselling initiatives to strengthen beverage mix and average check.
- Maintained consistent SOPs, recipe standards and service execution across opening/closing procedures and station preparation.

Head Bartender

Dec 2019 – Mar 2020

Nara Desert Escape, Dubai, UAE — Pre-Opening

- Progressed into greater operational responsibility and leadership, overseeing bar service standards and team performance.
- Led daily bar operations including station setup, stock preparation and closing procedures for a high-end desert dining and entertainment venue.
- Trained and supervised bartending staff on recipe standards, portioning and service consistency.
- Managed bar inventory, requisitions and par-level stock to minimize wastage and ensure uninterrupted service.
- Coordinated with kitchen and floor teams to align beverage service with event flow and guest experience standards.

- Monitored beverage cost and pour accuracy while maintaining quality and presentation standards during high-volume service.

Bartender

Jan 2019 – Nov 2019

Tasca by José Avillez, Mandarin Oriental Jumeira, Dubai, UAE — Pre-Opening

- Contributed to pre-opening setup for a luxury dining concept, including SOP development, product training and service standard implementation.
- Assisted in building the initial beverage menu, recipe specifications and cocktail costing ahead of launch.
- Supported bar equipment setup, glassware selection and station layout planning during the pre-opening phase.
- Participated in staff onboarding and training to align the team with Mandarin Oriental's luxury service standards.
- Delivered guest-facing bar service post-launch, ensuring consistency with brand recipe and presentation specifications.

Bartender

Feb 2015 – Nov 2018

Radisson Blu Hotel Dubai Media City, Dubai, UAE

- Built foundational beverage service experience in a high-volume hotel bar environment.
- Prepared and served a wide range of cocktails, spirits and beverages to hotel guests and walk-in patrons.
- Maintained bar cleanliness, stock levels and mise en place in line with hotel service standards.
- Handled cash and POS transactions accurately during busy service periods.
- Supported senior bar staff with inventory counts, stock rotation and opening/closing checklists.

DIGITAL INNOVATION & SELF-INITIATED PROJECTS

BarBible Interactive — Digital SOP & Staff Training Hub

- Designed and built a mobile-first platform replacing static SOP binders — staff can search recipes, check specifications, wash-lines, glassware and garnish references, complete opening/closing checklists, take pre-shift quizzes and review allergen information.
- Structured all operational content, recipe specifications and workflows; used digital and AI-assisted tools to build the interactive interface.
- Status: built and ready for rollout.

Cocktail Costing Calculator

- Designed and built a costing tool that calculates ingredient cost, total cocktail cost, pour cost %, gross profit and recommended selling price from bottle purchase price, recipe specifications and landed costs.
- Designed the underlying calculation logic to support target-margin pricing decisions.
- Status: built and ready for deployment (not yet live-tested).

PROFESSIONAL BEVERAGE COMPETITION EXPERIENCE

- Monkey Shoulder Ultimate Bartender Championship — Dubai, 2019
- Max Flair Bartender Challenge — Dubai, 2017
- Moscow Mule Competition — Dubai, 2016

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

- Bachelor of Tourism & Travel Management (BTTM) — Indira Gandhi National Open University (IGNOU), India — In Progress
- Diploma in Food & Beverage Service — Food Craft Institute, Perinthalmanna (2010)
- Diploma in Advanced Bartending in Mixology and Flair (2013)
- AI Prompt Engineering, "1 Million Prompts" — Dubai Future Foundation / Dubai Centre for Artificial Intelligence (2026)

TECHNOLOGY & AI TOOLKIT

- ChatGPT · Claude · Gemini · Perplexity · Microsoft Copilot · NotebookLM · Canva AI · Gamma

Operational Use

- Inventory & variance analysis · Beverage cost & KPI tracking · SOP/documentation · Workflow optimization · Management reporting · Data-driven decision support.

Digital Productivity

- Microsoft Excel · Word · PowerPoint · Google Workspace · Canva